TRUFFLE RAVIOLI

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
8	**2 h**

INGREDIENTS

300 g	Pasta Dough — pasta flour
3	Pasta Dough — eggs (+ 1 for egg wash)
1 tbsp	Pasta Dough — olive oil
100 ml	Truffle Filling — ruby port
50 ml	Truffle Filling — Madeira
25 ml	Truffle Filling — brandy
400 ml	Truffle Filling — brown chicken stock
400 ml	Truffle Filling — truffle juice
240 g	Truffle Filling — butter
40 ml	Truffle Filling — truffle oil (extra for garnish)
10 g	Truffle Filling — salt
16 g	Truffle Filling — gelatine (soaked)
6 g	Truffle Filling — agar agar
1	Garnish — white truffle (8 large shavings)
1 handful	Garnish — pea shoots
1 handful	Garnish — Parmesan shavings
1 pinch	Garnish — sea salt

METHOD

1. Start the dough: Place eggs, olive oil and flour in food processor. Pulse until combined. Knead to form smooth dough, wrap in cling film, rest 30 minutes in refrigerator.
2. Prepare truffle filling: Combine port, Madeira and brandy in small pan, reduce to 15ml. Add stock and truffle juice, bring to boil, skim off any fat or scum.
3. Finish filling: Remove from heat, whisk in butter, olive oil and salt. Place in thermomix with soaked gelatine and agar agar. Take up to 90°C on full speed for 30 seconds.
4. Set filling: Remove top from mixer, leave to set in refrigerator. Once set, blend again and place into small 2cm round silicone or rubber moulds.
5. Roll pasta: Roll through pasta machine, starting from widest setting, going down to between 0 and 1. Fold dough in half before rolling on settings 10, 7, 4, and 2 to develop gluten. Repeat on last setting for consistent finish. Pasta should be dry but elastic.
6. Form ravioli: Fold final piece in half, cut thin strip at folded edge to create 2 equal sheets. Place 1 sheet on floured surface, apply light even coat of egg wash. Remove truffle filling from moulds, place in 2 even rows of 4 along pasta. Cover with second sheet, press gently around each truffle ball to form dome. Cut out with 3cm pastry cutter. Pick up individually, squeeze out air, seal edges. Store on tea towel-lined tray.
7. Cook and serve: Cook in salted boiling water for 2-3 minutes until pasta is just cooked. Remove, toss with truffle oil and sea salt. Place on spoons or small serving dishes. Garnish with pea shoots, Parmesan shavings and slice of fresh truffle. Serve immediately.

NOTES

The combination of fresh truffle and warm truffle ravioli provides a rich explosion of flavour. This sophisticated recipe makes elegant canapés or a luxurious starter. To make it vegetarian, use vegetable stock instead of chicken stock, replace gelatine with extra agar agar and omit the Parmesan.
Chef's Tips: The truffle filling needs to be properly set before forming ravioli - don't rush the chilling time. Fresh truffle shavings are essential for the full experience. This is an impressive dinner party starter or elegant canapé.

FILLING
Truffle Filling

INGREDIENTS

100 ml	Ruby port
50 ml	Madeira
25 ml	Brandy
400 ml	Brown chicken stock
400 ml	Truffle juice
240 g	Butter
40 ml	Truffle oil (extra for garnish)
10 g	Salt
16 g	Gelatine, soaked
6 g	Agar agar

METHOD

1. Reduce the port, Madeira and brandy together to 15 ml.
2. Add the stock and truffle juice, bring to the boil and skim off fat and scum.
3. Off the heat, whisk in the butter, oil and salt.
4. Transfer to a thermomix with the soaked gelatine and agar agar, and run at full speed up to 90 C for 30 seconds.
5. Take the top off and leave to set in the fridge.
6. Blend the set mixture again, then pipe it into 2 cm round silicone or rubber moulds and let it set.

NOTES

A gel, not a paste. It has to be fully set and unmoulded before it meets the pasta, which is why the source says not to rush the chilling.
No sub-components, but two setting agents doing different jobs: gelatine for the melt, agar agar for the hold at 90 C.
Step 3 in the source says to whisk in olive oil, while the ingredient list gives truffle oil. The two do not agree and the source never resolves it.
Vegetarian version per the source: vegetable stock in place of chicken, extra agar agar in place of the gelatine (amount not given), and no Parmesan garnish.
Yields 8 canapé portions, laid in 2 rows of 4 and cut with a 3 cm cutter.

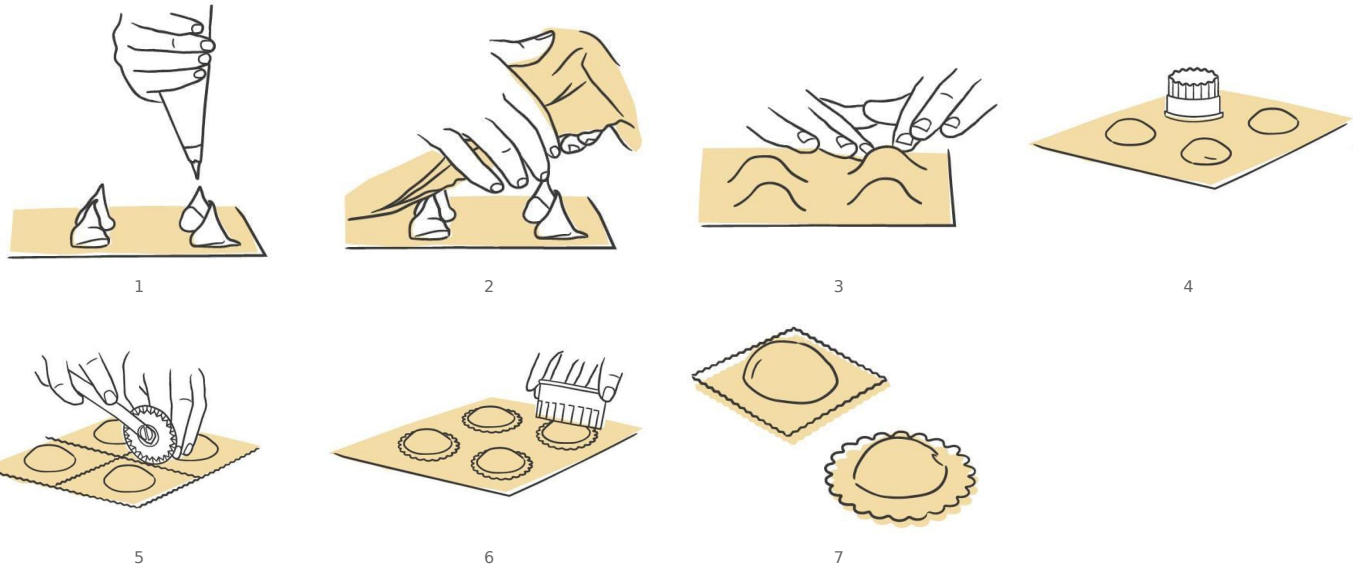
SHAPE
Ravioli

Region: All of Italy, north to south, and worldwide / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Trim the sheets to 18-inch lengths with a knife and cut away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet on the board. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1-inch opening, pipe mounds of filling roughly 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high in an even run down the sheet, leaving about 2 inches between mounds.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist it with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board so the second sheet will stick. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Lay a second sheet gently over the first, edges lined up and no wrinkles.
7. Press around each mound with your two index fingers to expel the air pockets. For insurance, flip a #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter to its dull side and press gently over each mound to expel the last of the air.
8. For square ravioli, cut 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted pastry cutter or fluted dough divider. A 2 1/2-inch fluted square cutter does the same thing.
9. For round ravioli, use a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter. Press straight down with your palm flat on top of the cutter, then twist it clockwise under that pressure to finish the cut.
10. Lift the sheets from one end to peel away the surrounding scrap. Discard it or save it for soup.
11. Set the pieces on the prepared pan in a single layer and dust the pan again with semolina.
12. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
13. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3 4 5 6 7

NOTES

Two-sheet construction from 18-inch sheets. The filling goes on the bottom sheet and a second sheet covers it.
Filling per piece: a mound 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high, piped through a 1-inch opening.
Spacing: mounds 2 inches apart. The cut is either a 2 1/2-inch square or a 2 3/8-inch round.
Cutters: #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter used dull side down to expel air, then either a fluted cutter or divider for 2 1/2-inch squares, or a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter for rounds.
Cutting technique for rounds: press with a flat palm, then rotate clockwise under pressure so the cut goes all the way through.
Air is expelled twice before cutting, first with two index fingers and then with the dull cutter.
The author's restaurant version is round, roughly 2 inches across, with a ruffled edge. The square version is the red-sauce shape.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Red sauce is the default finish. Otherwise the shape is a test bed for any filling.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.